

NAIL062 Propositional and predicate logic: Information about exams

Winter semester 2026/27

Exam dates

Register for exam dates in the Study Information System. The credit from the tutorial is required to register for the exam, with the exception of early exam dates. We strongly recommend **at least two attempts during the winter examination period**.

Several additional exam dates will be offered after the end of the winter examination period; however, their capacity will be limited, and **priority** will be given to third attempts, followed by second attempts, and only if there is remaining capacity will students taking the exam for the first time be admitted. For these purposes, missed exam dates (when a student registered for the exam did not attend and their absence was not justified in a timely and sufficient manner) will also be deducted from the number of attempts.

In the summer semester, we plan to offer **three exam dates with a capacity of 16 students**. We plan the last exam date for **April**. These dates will initially be listed with a capacity of 0, and after 48 hours have elapsed since registration opens, students will be manually enrolled from the waitlist according to the rules above.

Registration and cancellation

You can register for the exam, as well as cancel your registration, no later than 24 hours before the exam date starts. Please check less than 24 hours before the exam to see if another student's cancellation has changed your allocated exam time. Please note that the times are tentative, some delay often occurs.

Do not stay on the waitlist for an exam date you do not intend to take. If a spot opens up (which often happens at the last minute), you will be automatically registered and cannot cancel within 24 hours of the exam. In addition, the system will deregister you from any other exam date.

Exam rules

- You must bring your student ID and may bring a drinking bottle. Nothing else is allowed at your assigned desk. Pen and paper will be provided. (You may leave your personal belongings inside the classroom but not at your desk.)
- Any electronic devices, phones, smartwatches, wearables, headphones, etc. as well as regular watches are strictly prohibited.
- No talking or whispering to yourself during the preparation time.
- Bathroom breaks are not allowed during the exam.

Exam Requirements

The exam requirements correspond to the material covered in the lectures and described in the slides, with the exception of the following, which will not be required (the section numbers refer to the lecture notes):

- Section 2.5 Algebra of Propositions,
- Section 3.1 SAT Solvers,
- Section 3.4 The DPLL Algorithm,
- Section 4.8 Hilbert Calculus,
- Section 5.4 LI-resolution and Horn-SAT,
- Subsection 6.8.1 Database Queries,

- Section 7.6 Hilbert Calculus in Predicate Logic,
- Section 8.7 LI-resolution,
- Knowledge of proofs from Section 10.4 Gödel's Theorems will not be required.

Exam format and grading

The exam is oral, with written preparation phase (for which you will have 30 minutes). During the exam, you can be asked about any of the requirements, but the core of the exam will consist of an assignment that you will draw prior to the preparation phase. The assignment consists of three questions: “definition”, “easy question”, “hard question” from the lists below.

- **Definition:** Give a formal definition of the given concept, some non-trivial example (possibly also an example of an object that does not meet the given definition). Be prepared to answer questions about related properties.
- **Easy question:** If it is a mathematical statement, formulate and prove it. If it is an algorithm, formulate it, you can prepare a sample run of the algorithm, provide proof of correctness or other properties from the lecture.
- **Hard question:** Formulate the given mathematical theorem and give its proof, including auxiliary lemmata. If it is an immediate consequence of another theorem from the lecture, give the proof of that theorem as well. Be prepared to explain all the necessary notions from the formulation, and discuss the corollaries and applications of the theorem.

Tentative assessment

The following tentative assessment will be applied if no other deficiencies are uncovered. The evaluation can be even worse if during the exam we come across a fundamental lack of understanding of a concept or, for example, a serious misunderstanding of the proof written during the preparation phase.

- **Excellent:** Answer the *definition* and *hard question* including proof, answer the *easy question* if asked. Possible minor errors removed with just a little help from the examiner. Satisfactory answers to follow-up questions.
- **Very good:** Answering the *definition*, *easy question* (including proof, unless it is stated that the question is without proof) and formulation of the theorem from the *hard question* (without proof). Possible errors are corrected with the help of the examiner. Answering additional questions, possibly with hints.
- **Good:** Answering the *definition* and formulating the theorem from the *hard question*, there may be substantial errors, but the student must be able to correct them with help from the examiner. An answer to the *easy question* that is mostly correct, any errors or gaps in the proof removed with the help of the examiner. The ability to answer supplementary questions with the help of the examiner, the examination will not show a lack of understanding of basic concepts and context.
- **Fail:** In all other cases.

A lack of understanding of basic concepts and context, leading to a grade of “Fail” on the examination, cannot be characterized exhaustively. Nevertheless, to give an idea, here are several examples from previous years:

- Inability to provide an example of a syntactically well-formed formula or theory in the given language.
- Inability to correctly describe a structure that is a model of a given (simple) first-order theory.

- Inability to clearly define fundamental notions such as the validity of a formula in a theory or an inconsistent theory.
- Inability to fill in trivial steps in a proof, for example, in the proof of the Compactness Theorem, the fact that a model of a theory is also a model of each of its finite subsets, or that a theory has no model if and only if the contradiction is valid in it.

List of exam questions

Here is a list of the definitions (D), easy questions (E) and hard questions (H) that will be tested. If you draw a question that is the same as a student whose exam is taking place or will take place at the same time as yours, you may be asked to take a new draw. (Questions are randomly generated, but the probability distribution is secret and not necessarily uniform.) If the given definition, theorem, etc. was stated in both propositional and predicate logic, be prepared to answer the question in both propositional and predicate logic, unless specified otherwise.

List of definitions

- (D1) Model in propositional logic, truth function of a proposition.
- (D2) Semantic concepts (truth, falsity, independence, satisfiability) in logic, relative to a theory.
- (D3) Equivalence of propositions or propositional theories, T-equivalence.
- (D4) Semantic notions about a theory (contradictory, consistent, complete, satisfiable).
- (D5) Extensions of theories (simple, conservative), the corresponding semantic criteria.
- (D6) Tableau from a theory, tableau proof.
- (D7) Congruence of a structure, quotient structure, axioms of equality.
- (D8) CNF and DNF, Horn formulas. Set representation of CNF formulas, satisfying assignment.
- (D9) Resolution rule, (most general) unification, resolution proof and refutation.
- (D10) Signature and language of predicate logic, structure of the given language.
- (D11) Atomic formula, formula, sentence, open formula.
- (D12) Truth value of a formula in a structure with respect to an assignment, validity of a formula in a structure.
- (D13) Complete theories in predicate logic, elementary equivalence.
- (D14) Substructure, generated substructure, expansion and reduct.
- (D15) Definability in a structure.
- (D16) Extension by definitions.
- (D17) Prenex normal form, Skolem variant.
- (D18) Isomorphism of structures.
- (D19) Axiomatizability, finite axiomatizability, open axiomatizability.
- (D20) Recursive axiomatization, recursive axiomatizability, recursively enumerable completion.
- (D21) Decidable and partially decidable theory.

List of easy questions

- (E1) Any set of models over a finite language can be axiomatized by a proposition in CNF, and by a proposition in DNF.
- (E2) 2-SAT, the implication graph algorithm, its correctness.
- (E3) Horn-SAT, the unit propagation algorithm, its correctness.

- (E4) Properties of extension by definitions.
- (E5) The relation between definable sets and automorphisms.
- (E6) The compactness theorem and its applications.
- (E7) Soundness of resolution in propositional logic.
- (E8) Soundness of resolution in predicate logic.
- (E9) Non-standard model of natural numbers.
- (E10) The existence of a countable algebraically closed field.
- (E11) The criterion for open axiomatizability.
- (E12) Recursively axiomatized theories are partially decidable, complete are decidable.
- (E13) Gödel's incompleteness theorems and their consequences (without proofs).

List of hard questions

- (H1) Soundness of the tableau method in propositional logic.
- (H2) Soundness of the tableau method in predicate logic.
- (H3) Completeness of the tableau method in propositional logic.
- (H4) Completeness of the tableau method in predicate logic.
- (H5) Finiteness of contradiction, corollaries about finiteness and systematicity of proofs.
- (H6) Completeness of resolution in propositional logic.
- (H7) Completeness of resolution in predicate logic (the proof of the Lifting lemma is not required).
- (H8) Skolem's theorem.
- (H9) Herbrand's Theorem.
- (H10) Löwenheim-Skolem theorem including its variant with equality, their consequences.
- (H11) Non-axiomatizability of finite models.
- (H12) The theorem about finite axiomatizability.
- (H13) Decidability of a recursively axiomatized theory with recursively enumerable completion.